

# UC BERKELEY HAAS

---

## INSIDER TIPS



# ABOUT HAAS

As the second-oldest business school in the US, the Haas School of Business at the University of California, Berkeley, has been questioning the status quo since its founding in 1898. The Berkeley Haas mission is to help extraordinary people achieve great things. At Haas, its distinctive culture is expressed through the four Defining Leadership Principles: Question the Status Quo, Confidence Without Attitude, Students Always, and Beyond Yourself. The Berkeley Haas culture fosters new thinking and new tools to change careers—and markets.

Across every dimension, Haas students, faculty, and staff are characterized by the high quality of their work, their exceptional talents and creativity, their diversity of experience, and their commitment to inclusiveness. Applicants select Berkeley Haas in order to join a diverse global community of people who use the tools of business to make a positive impact. Students work with and alongside others who embrace our Defining Leadership Principles—and see how their role is to contribute to a larger purpose.

Anchored in a rigorous general management curriculum, Haas links its courses and programs across disciplines at Berkeley and puts a premium on flexibility, allowing students to customize a program of study to their interests and design their own electives.

## **STRENGTHS & SPECIALIZATIONS**

Entrepreneurship, General Management, Healthcare, Innovation, International Management, Nonprofit/Social Responsibility, Organizational Behavior, Research Institutes & Centers, Tech.

# KEY STATS

| MBA RANKINGS*   | 2017 | 2018 | 2019 | 2020 | 2021 |
|-----------------|------|------|------|------|------|
| BusinessWeek    | 11   | 6    | 8    | 8    | *    |
| Financial Times | 13   | 10   | 10   | 12   | *    |
| Forbes          | 9    | -    | 11   | -    | -    |
| The Economist   | 7    | 11   | 7    | -    | *    |
| US News         | 7    | 7    | 6    | 7    | 7    |

## CLASS OF 2022 ADMISSIONS

|                        |             |                 |      |
|------------------------|-------------|-----------------|------|
| Number of Applicants   | 3696        | Avg Age         | 28   |
| MBA Class Size         | 331         | Avg GMAT        | 727  |
| Admissions selectivity | 23.3%       | Avg GPA         | 3.65 |
| Yield                  | 38.44%      | % International | 21%  |
| Total Tuition          | US\$136,888 | % Women         | 39%  |

## POST-MBA CAREERS (CLASS OF 2020)

|                       |       |
|-----------------------|-------|
| Technology            | 32.4% |
| Consulting            | 25.1% |
| Financial Services    | 14.5% |
| Health/BioTech/Pharma | 11.6% |

## TOP RECRUITERS INCLUDE:

Adobe, Amazon, Bain & Company, Goldman Sachs, Google, BCG, Cisco, Deloitte, L.E.K., McKinsey, EY-Parthenon, Genentec, Visa

**AVERAGE BASE SALARY:** **US\$139,423**

**EMPLOYED IN 3 MONTHS:** **89.5%**

\*Rankings are relative to other U.S. business schools. [Read more](#) about the Fortuna ranking methodology.



# TOP TIPS FOR ACING YOUR HAAS APPLICATION

**BY SHARON JOYCE**

With over 25 years of experience in admissions and student affairs, Sharon is a seasoned professional in higher education who has been lauded for her innovative approaches in streamlining interview processes at multiple institutions and her efforts to create inclusive communities in graduate education. At UC Berkeley's Haas School of Business, she served as the Associate Director of Admissions for the full-time program MBA program, while also collaborating on the overall strategic plan for Haas admissions as a member of the Senior Management team.



**Through the essays, the Admissions Committee is seeking to uncover the less visible forces that shape candidates' lives, opportunities, decisions, and character.**

# 1

## THE FOUR LEADERSHIP PRINCIPLES ARE A REAL THING

The four principles – Question the Status Quo, Confidence Without Attitude, Students Always, and Beyond Yourself – are truly reflective of the school’s culture and not just marketing fodder. Prepare to demonstrate how and why these principles speak to you. In the Haas interview, for example, you may be asked which one resonates most. There isn’t a right or wrong reply to this and it’s not a trick, but your ability to be authentic and honest in response depends on whether you’ve taken the time to get introspective about both the principles and your fit with the program.

## DIVERSITY OF CULTURES AND PERSPECTIVES IS PARAMOUNT

# 2

The school is committed to recruiting the most diverse students, faculty, and staff to enhance the mission, community, and academic excellence. Through the essays, the Admissions Committee is seeking to uncover the less visible forces that shape candidates’ lives, opportunities, decisions, and character. Express your values, political engagement, awareness of social justice, and/or access to education in terms of social mobility – all of which are very important to Haas. This school seeks students who demonstrate self-awareness and community engagement, which is an invitation to recognize your privilege and convey a deep understanding of what that means to you. Haas genuinely fosters a climate of inclusion, empathy, and compassion. Even if you don’t identify as a member of a marginalized group, it can be valuable to show how you are an ally and welcoming of different ways of thinking, which ties to Questioning the Status Quo and Beyond Yourself.

# 3

## PRIDE IN BEING PART OF A WORD-RECOGNIZED PUBLIC INSTITUTION

It's important to demonstrate some awareness that Berkeley Haas is part of the University of California system, with Berkeley being its flagship campus. The University of California was founded in 1868, born out of a vision in the State Constitution of a university that would "contribute even more than California's gold to the glory and happiness of advancing generations." UC Berkeley students – Haas students included – are reputed to be "scrappier" than peers at private institutions as well as lauded by recruiters for being less "entitled," which ties directly to the Confidence Without Attitude principle.

## IT'S OKAY TO BE A LITTLE BIT "BEZERKELEY"

# 4

The term "Beserkeley" has a history in popular culture and media lingo. In 2004, the current top definition for the word "Bezerkeley," a popular spelling variant of the word, was created on Urban Dictionary. The word as read on the site is defined simply as "Berkeley, California," as if the name of the city alone were enough to express the out-there atmosphere associated with the locale. How does this apply to Berkeley Haas? The Admissions Committee does place some value on being a bit quirky – if this is authentically who you are. (But don't fake it if you're not!) The acceptance of those who might have taken a path less traveled, or who have an unusual talent or hobby, is what makes the Haas student body so unique. The essay prompts tend to be less conventional by design; the admissions committee wants to find out what makes you tick, up and beyond your work and academic acumen. You should approach the prompts with enthusiasm, gusto and as a signal of your fit for the program.

# 5

## COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT IS REQUISITE

The student-driven and deeply participatory atmosphere at Haas is another vital differentiator to connect to your narrative. Haas's culture of engagement extends beyond studies into institutional operations, with feedback loops between student government and every administrative function/office within the program. Student viewpoints are taken very seriously and are actively solicited. Admissions interviews are predominately conducted by student interviewers, for example, and their reviews of candidates are weighed equally to those conducted by alumni and professional staff.

As such, if you're among the fortunate to be invited to interview, know that current students, who serve as interviewers, can be tough evaluators. You will need to cite two-to-three clubs you plan to join at Haas, as well as link at least one club with experience or position you've served in the past to demonstrate your commitment, sincerity and track record of community engagement. So earlier on in the application process, be sure to reach out to student leadership to have a few examples of how you'll be an active participant.

For more insider insights into Haas please visit  
the [Fortuna Blog](#).

# DEADLINES & DATES

|              | APPLICATION<br>DEADLINE | DECISION<br>NOTIFICATION |
|--------------|-------------------------|--------------------------|
| 1st Deadline | 23 September 2021       | 16 December 2021         |
| 2nd Deadline | 06 January 2022         | 24 March 2022            |
| 3rd Deadline | 07 April 2022           | 12 May 2022              |



**The best time to  
apply is when you're  
ready.**

Caroline Diarte Edwards,  
Co-Founder & Director of Fortuna Admissions

# LET'S GET YOU IN.

Fortuna Admissions is a dream team of former MBA Admissions Directors and Officers from the top-tier business schools, including Wharton, INSEAD, Harvard Business School, Stanford GSB, Kellogg, LBS, Chicago Booth, MIT Sloan, Columbia, NYU Stern, IE, Duke Fuqua, UCLA Anderson, Yale SOM, Cornell Johnson and Berkeley Haas.

As industry experts, we regularly provide commentary and analysis about b-school admissions for major media around the world. To read our full range of advice visit: [FortunaAdmissions.com](https://FortunaAdmissions.com)

With our unparalleled collective expertise, we are able to coach you to develop a clear vision of your goals for business school and beyond. We work closely with you throughout the application process and provide expert guidance at every stage to maximize your chances of admission to a top school.

Our free consultations are consistently rated as the best in the industry. To learn more about Fortuna and assess your chances of admission, reserve yours at: [FortunaAdmissions.com](https://FortunaAdmissions.com)

